

Lab 1: Install Hermes Agent and Run a Safe First Session

Duration: 35 minutes

Topic: 3

Objective

Install Hermes through the official path, complete provider setup, verify the runtime and run a bounded read-only task.

Deliverable

An installation verification record with version, doctor result, provider route, session evidence and cleanup status.

Prerequisites

- A trainer-approved laptop and classroom workspace.
- Use only fictional data supplied in this lab.
- Do not paste API keys, customer data or personal information into evidence.
- A provider account or trainer-provided classroom route; never submit its credential.

Procedure

Step 1: Open the official Hermes repository and verify the publisher is NousResearch and the connection uses HTTPS.

Step 2: Review the installer before execution if required by organisational policy. On macOS, Linux or WSL2, run the official installer.

```
curl -fsSL https://hermes-agent.nousresearch.com/install.sh | bash
```

Step 3: Reload the shell so the hermes command is on PATH.

```
source ~/.zshrc # macOS zsh  
# or: source ~/.bashrc
```

Step 4: Start the setup wizard. Select the trainer-approved provider and store credentials only in the Hermes-managed location.

```
hermes setup
```

Step 5: Record version and diagnostics without recording secret values.

```
hermes --version  
hermes doctor  
hermes config check
```

Step 6: Start Hermes in the lab folder and ask it to summarise the fictional business brief without changing files.

```
hermes
```

Step 7: Confirm the response cites the supplied brief, states uncertainty and makes no external action.

Step 8: Complete installation-verification.md and run the bundle verifier.

```
python3 verify.py
```

Step 9: Exit the session. If a classroom credential was temporary, revoke it with the trainer.

Acceptance test

Hermes starts, diagnostics identify a configured provider, the first response uses only fictional evidence, and installation-verification.md is complete.

Evidence checklist

- ☐ Commands or configuration used (with secrets redacted)
- ☐ Screenshot or generated-file evidence
- ☐ Acceptance test result
- ☐ One failure and how it was resolved
- ☐ Reflection: one control or improvement

Safety and cleanup

- Use fictional data only.
- Never submit .env, tokens, keys or personal information.
- Stop classroom gateways and remove recurring jobs after evidence capture.

References

- [Official course page](#)
- [Hermes Agent repository](#)
- [Hermes Agent documentation](#)
- [Hermes tools reference](#)
- [Hermes toolsets reference](#)
- [Hermes skills](#)
- [Hermes memory](#)
- [Hermes context files](#)
- [Hermes security](#)
- [Hermes subagents](#)
- [Hermes Kanban](#)
- [Hermes video tools](#)
- Generative AI for Business Innovation — Reference ebook by Brajesh De, 2026

- The Agentic AI Revolution — Reference ebook by Will Hawkins and Nancie Calder, 2025
- Mastering AI Agents — Reference ebook by Marcus Lighthaven, 2025
- Untangling AI — Reference ebook by Matt Kesby, 2026